
FamilyFinanceChat

Fall 2026: make it solid, give it a face

Professor Mark Fedenia directing the project

FIN 602 Capstone Engineering Team

For a spring class in Wealth Management & Financial Planning

FamilyFinanceChat

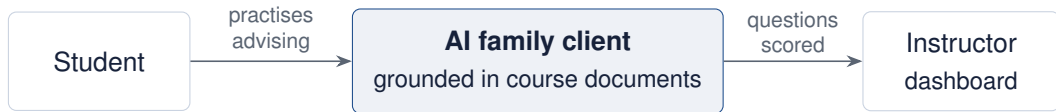
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Five minutes. Two things: finish making the platform solid, and try something new – an avatar the student can talk to.



Unlimited practice, at any hour, without booking a human role-player.

What we have

One sentence each way: students get unlimited practice, instructors get automatic scoring instead of reading every transcript.



Unlimited practice, at any hour, without booking a human role-player.

- 1 We are **three versions behind** the software we run on.
- 2 The professor's grading tool **runs on a laptop**, not a website.
- 3 Every deployment needs **manual steps** that people forget.

The gap between *a system that works* and *a system you can hand over*.

└ It works. Three things hurt.

- 1 We are **three versions behind** the software we run on.
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The gap between a *system that works* and a *system you can hand over*.

Don't elaborate. Three problems, one sentence each. The last line is the framing.

Never modify Open WebUI's core.

Before

6,500 lines

of their code, forked by us
stuck on one old version



Now

1 line

we just use their release
upgrade any time

The test: *could we take their next release tomorrow, unchanged?*

└ The one rule

Never modify Open WebUI's core.

Before	→	Now
6,500 lines		1 line
of their code, forked by us		we just use their release
stuck on one old version		upgrade any time

The test: could we take their next release tomorrow, unchanged?

The most important slide. The last team removed the fork; our job is to never let it back. Everything else follows from this.

- Upgrade to the **current version** — carefully, one step at a time
- Give the professor a **web address** instead of a laptop
- **Automate** deployment and testing, so upgrades stop breaking things quietly
- **Delete** the last remnants of the old fork

└ First job: make it solid

Four items. Unglamorous, and it is what the course actually depends on. Do not go deeper — the plan has the detail.

- Upgrade to the [current version](#) — carefully, one step at a time
- Give the professor a [web address](#) instead of a laptop
- [Automate](#) deployment and testing, so upgrades stop breaking things quietly
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Today the student *types* to the client.

We want them to talk to it.

A face that listens, and answers out loud.

You cannot rehearse a hard question about money
when you have a backspace key.

└ Second job: give the client a face

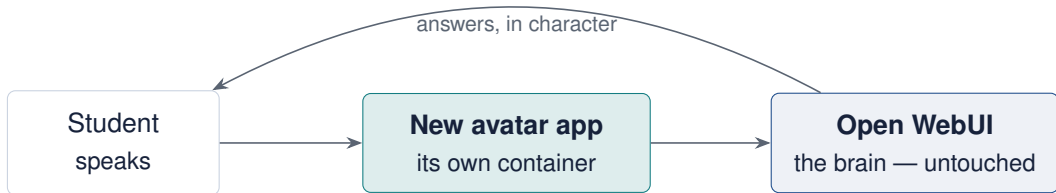
Today the student *types* to the client.

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The pitch. Real advising happens out loud, in real time, with someone looking at you. Typing removes the exact pressure we are trying to teach.



A **separate app** beside the platform — never inside it.

If it does not work out, we delete one container. Nothing to unpick.

How — without breaking the rule



A **separate app** beside the platform — never inside it.

If it does not work out, we delete one container. Nothing to unpick.

The rule on slide 4 chose this architecture for us — and it is the better one. Same brain, same documents, same grading.

1.2 s

to answer

Slower than that and it stops
feeling like a conversation.

\$400

per semester

Roughly, for a class of forty.
Capped, so it cannot run away.

Week 2

consent settled

Voice and video are student
records. Agreed before
anything is recorded.

└ Three numbers decide whether it works

Speed, money, permission. If any one of them fails, the answer is no – and no is an acceptable answer.

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29 Sep Students can **talk to it** — voice only, no face yet

20 Oct Pick an avatar provider — **or decide to stop**

27 Oct Platform **upgraded** and running current

17 Nov Five students complete **full spoken sessions**, graded normally

Weekly check-in every Tuesday, 15 September to 1 December.

Voice-only ships in September either way. *The avatar is allowed to fail.*

The semester

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Four checkpoints. Stress week five — the safe version ships early, which is what makes the risky version safe to attempt.

- A professor grades from **a web address** — no laptop
- Deployments are **automatic**; bad changes never ship
- We know, **with evidence**, whether the avatar helps

The goal is not to finish this system.
It is to leave one where the interesting work is
the teaching, not the plumbing.

└ What finished looks like

- A professor grades from a **web address** — no laptop
- Deployments are **automatic**; bad changes never ship
- We know, **with evidence**, whether the avatar helps

The goal is not to finish this system.

It is to leave one where the interesting work is
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Close on purpose, then stop talking and take questions — the reports have every detail anyone will ask for.